

Chapter 7: Parking, Stopping, or Standing

Not all crashes happen while a vehicle is moving. An improperly parked vehicle may also cause a crash. When you leave your vehicle, turn the motor off, set the parking brake and remove the key. Be sure to look behind you for any oncoming traffic before opening your car door.

Do Not Park, Stop, or Stand a Vehicle

In the following situations, you should not park, stop, or allow a vehicle to stand idling:

1. On the road side of any vehicle stopped or parked at the edge or curb of a street
2. On a sidewalk or crosswalk
3. Within an intersection
4. Between a safety zone and adjacent curb or within 30 feet of a place on the curb immediately opposite the end of a safety zone
5. Alongside or opposite of any street excavation or obstruction when stopping, standing, or parking would obstruct traffic
6. On a bridge or other elevated structure on a highway or within a highway tunnel
7. On any railroad track
8. At any place where an official sign prohibits stopping

Do Not Park or Stand a Vehicle

Whether occupied or not, do not park or allow a vehicle to stand idling:

1. In front of a public or private driveway
2. Within 15 feet of a fire hydrant
3. Within 20 feet of a crosswalk at an intersection
4. Within 30 feet upon the approach to any flashing signal, stop sign, yield sign, or other traffic control signal located at the side of a road
5. Within 20 feet of the driveway entrance to any fire station and on the side of a street opposite the entrance to any fire station within 75 feet of entrance
6. At any place where an official sign prohibits parking or standing

Special Note:
Temporarily stopping to obey signs, signals, etc. is not considered parking or standing.

Do Not Park a Vehicle

1. Do not park a vehicle, occupied or not, within 50 feet of the nearest rail of a railroad crossing.
2. Do not park a vehicle at any place where an official sign prohibits parking.

Parking, Stopping, or Standing on a Highway Outside an Urban Area

Never park or leave a vehicle to stand idling on the paved part of any highway outside of a business or residential district when you can park off the road. If you cannot park off the road:

1. Leave plenty of room for others to pass
2. Be sure your vehicle can be seen for at least 200 feet from each direction
3. If at night, use your parking lights or leave your headlights on dim
4. A person may stop, stand, or park a bicycle on a sidewalk if the bicycle does not impede the normal and reasonable movement of pedestrian or other traffic on the sidewalk.

Disabled Parking

It is a violation for a person to park, stand, or stop a vehicle in a parking space designated as disabled parking. Illegally parking in a space reserved for individuals with disabilities is a misdemeanor punishable by a fine of \$500 to \$750 for the first offense. This fine increases with additional offenses up to \$1,250 for five or more offenses. Additional offenses also include community service.